

HEARING HALTED ON LEFTIST GROUP

Subversive Activities Board Officer Adjourns Session Here After Controversy

The Civil Rights Congress hearing before the Subversive Activities Board was adjourned abruptly yesterday when it threatened to get out of hand.

Following an oral exchange between the hearing officer and defense counsel, the former suddenly called off the hearing and said it would reconvene at a later date in Washington.

The hearing was conducted in the United States Courthouse, Foley Square, to determine whether the Civil Rights Congress must register as a Communist-front organization under the Internal Security Act.

David J. Coddair terminated the session without completing the testimony of the third defense witness. David Brown, 49-year-old former chairman of the Los Angeles Civil Rights Congress, was being cross-examined about his reading of *The Daily Worker*. Brown had testified earlier that as a Federal Bureau of Investigation informer he had continually lied to the Government.

Mr. Coddair warned Brown not to volunteer statements beyond answers to the questions. He announced: "I'm going to conduct an orderly hearing or we're not going to have a hearing in New York—I can tell you that."

Rhoda Laks, defense counsel, rose and denied the respondent was disorderly. After Mr. Coddair had asked her three times to be seated, she remained standing and he adjourned the hearing to be reconvened later in Washington.